

BibInVs MN 29

Joel

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 29*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Joel

Joel 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message to Joel son of Pethuel:
- 1 The word of the LORD that came to Joel son of Pethuel.
- 2 Attention, elder statesmen! Listen closely, everyone, whoever and wherever you are! Have you ever heard of anything like this? Has anything like this ever happened before--ever?
- 2 Hear this, you elders; listen, all who live in the land. Has anything like this ever happened in your days or in the days of your forefathers?
- 3 Make sure you tell your children, and your children tell their children, And their children their children. Don't let this message die out.
- 3 Tell it to your children, and let your children tell it to their children, and their children to the next generation.
- 4 What the chewing locust left, the gobbling locust ate; What the gobbling locust left, the munching locust ate; What the munching locust left, the chomping locust ate.
- 4 What the locust swarm has left the great locusts have eaten; what the great locusts have left the young locusts have eaten; what the young locusts have left other locusts have eaten.
- 5 Sober up, you drunks! Get in touch with reality--and weep! Your supply of booze is cut off. You're on the wagon, like it or not.
- 5 Wake up, you drunkards, and weep! Wail, all you drinkers of wine; wail because of the new wine, for it has been snatched from your lips.
- 6 My country's being invaded by an army invincible, past numbering, Teeth like those of a lion, fangs like those of a tiger.
- 6 A nation has invaded my land, powerful and without number; it has the teeth of a lion, the fangs of a lioness.
- 7 It has ruined my vineyards, stripped my orchards, And clear-cut the country. The landscape's a moonscape.

- 7 It has laid waste my vines and ruined my fig trees. It has stripped off their bark and thrown it away, leaving their branches white.
- 8 Weep like a young virgin dressed in black, mourning the loss of her fiancé.
- 8 Mourn like a virgin in sackcloth grieving for the husband of her youth.
- 9 Without grain and grapes, worship has been brought to a standstill in the Sanctuary of GOD. The priests are at a loss. GOD's ministers don't know what to do.
- 9 Grain offerings and drink offerings are cut off from the house of the LORD. The priests are in mourning, those who minister before the LORD.
- 10 The fields are sterile. The very ground grieves. The wheat fields are lifeless, vineyards dried up, olive oil gone.
- 10 The fields are ruined, the ground is dried up; the grain is destroyed, the new wine is dried up, the oil fails.
- 11 Dirt farmers, despair! Grape growers, wring your hands! Lament the loss of wheat and barley. All crops have failed.
- 11 Despair, you farmers, wail, you vine growers; grieve for the wheat and the barley, because the harvest of the field is destroyed.
- 12 Vineyards dried up, fig trees withered, Pomegranates, date palms, and apple trees-- deadwood everywhere! And joy is dried up and withered in the hearts of the people.
- 12 The vine is dried up and the fig tree is withered; the pomegranate, the palm and the apple tree-- all the trees of the field--are dried up. Surely the joy of mankind is withered away.
- 13 And also you priests, put on your robes and join the outcry. You who lead people in worship, lead them in lament. Spend the night dressed in gunnysacks, you servants of my God. Nothing's going on in the place of worship, no offerings, no prayers--nothing.
- 13 Put on sackcloth, O priests, and mourn; wail, you who minister before the altar. Come, spend the night in sackcloth, you who minister before my God; for the grain offerings and drink offerings are withheld from the house of your God.
- 14 Declare a holy fast, call a special meeting, get the leaders together, Round up everyone in the country. Get them into GOD's Sanctuary for serious prayer to GOD.

- 14 Declare a holy fast; call a sacred assembly. Summon the elders and all who live in the land to the house of the LORD your God, and cry out to the LORD.
- 15 What a day! Doomsday! GOD's Judgment Day has come. The Strong God has arrived. This is serious business!
- 15 Alas for that day! For the day of the LORD is near; it will come like destruction from the Almighty.
- 16 Food is just a memory at our tables, as are joy and singing from God's Sanctuary.
- 16 Has not the food been cut off before our very eyes-- joy and gladness from the house of our God?
- 17 The seeds in the field are dead, barns deserted, Grain silos abandoned. Who needs them? The crops have failed!
- 17 The seeds are shriveled beneath the clods. The storehouses are in ruins, the granaries have been broken down, for the grain has dried up.
- 18 The farm animals groan--oh, how they groan! The cattle mill around. There's nothing for them to eat. Not even the sheep find anything.
- 18 How the cattle moan! The herds mill about because they have no pasture; even the flocks of sheep are suffering.
- 19 GOD! I pray, I cry out to you! The fields are burning up, The country is a dust bowl, forest and prairie fires rage unchecked.
- 19 To you, O LORD, I call, for fire has devoured the open pastures and flames have burned up all the trees of the field.
- 20 Wild animals, dying of thirst, look to you for a drink. Springs and streams are dried up. The whole country is burning up.
- 20 Even the wild animals pant for you; the streams of water have dried up and fire has devoured the open pastures.

Joel 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Blow the ram's horn trumpet in Zion! Trumpet the alarm on my holy mountain! Shake the country up! GOD's Judgment's on its way--the Day's almost here!

- 1 Blow the trumpet in Zion; sound the alarm on my holy hill. Let all who live in the land tremble, for the day of the LORD is coming. It is close at hand--
- 2 A black day! A Doomsday! Clouds with no silver lining! Like dawn light moving over the mountains, a huge army is coming. There's never been anything like it and never will be again.
- 2 a day of darkness and gloom, a day of clouds and blackness. Like dawn spreading across the mountains a large and mighty army comes, such as never was of old nor ever will be in ages to come.
- 3 Wildfire burns everything before this army and fire licks up everything in its wake. Before it arrives, the country is like the Garden of Eden. When it leaves, it is Death Valley. Nothing escapes unscathed.
- 3 Before them fire devours, behind them a flame blazes. Before them the land is like the garden of Eden, behind them, a desert waste-- nothing escapes them.
- 4 The locust army seems all horses-- galloping horses, an army of horses.
- 4 They have the appearance of horses; they gallop along like cavalry.
- 5 It sounds like thunder leaping on mountain ridges, Or like the roar of wildfire through grass and brush, Or like an invincible army shouting for blood, ready to fight, straining at the bit.
- 5 With a noise like that of chariots they leap over the mountaintops, like a crackling fire consuming stubble, like a mighty army drawn up for battle.
- 6 At the sight of this army, the people panic, faces white with terror.
- 6 At the sight of them, nations are in anguish; every face turns pale.
- 7 The invaders charge. They climb barricades. Nothing stops them. Each soldier does what he's told, so disciplined, so determined.
- 7 They charge like warriors; they scale walls like soldiers. They all march in line, not swerving from their course.
- 8 They don't get in each other's way. Each one knows his job and does it. Undaunted and fearless, unswerving, unstoppable.
- 8 They do not jostle each other; each marches straight ahead. They plunge through defenses without breaking ranks.
- 9 They storm the city, swarm its defenses, Loot the houses, breaking down doors, smashing windows.

- 9 They rush upon the city; they run along the wall. They climb into the houses; like thieves they enter through the windows.
- 10 They arrive like an earthquake, sweep through like a tornado. Sun and moon turn out their lights, stars black out.
- 10 Before them the earth shakes, the sky trembles, the sun and moon are darkened, and the stars no longer shine.
- 11 GOD himself bellows in thunder as he commands his forces. Look at the size of that army! And the strength of those who obey him! GOD's Judgment Day--great and terrible. Who can possibly survive this?
- 11 The LORD thunders at the head of his army; his forces are beyond number, and mighty are those who obey his command. The day of the LORD is great; it is dreadful. Who can endure it?
- 12 But there's also this, it's not too late-- GOD's personal Message!-- "Come back to me and really mean it! Come fasting and weeping, sorry for your sins!"
- 12 Even now, declares the LORD, "return to me with all your heart, with fasting and weeping and mourning."
- 13 Change your life, not just your clothes. Come back to GOD, your God. And here's why: God is kind and merciful. He takes a deep breath, puts up with a lot, This most patient God, extravagant in love, always ready to cancel catastrophe.
- 13 Rend your heart and not your garments. Return to the LORD your God, for he is gracious and compassionate, slow to anger and abounding in love, and he relents from sending calamity.
- 14 Who knows? Maybe he'll do it now, maybe he'll turn around and show pity. Maybe, when all's said and done, there'll be blessings full and robust for your GOD!
- 14 Who knows? He may turn and have pity and leave behind a blessing-- grain offerings and drink offerings for the LORD your God.
- 15 Blow the ram's horn trumpet in Zion! Declare a day of repentance, a holy fast day. Call a public meeting.
- 15 Blow the trumpet in Zion, declare a holy fast, call a sacred assembly.
- 16 Get everyone there. Consecrate the congregation. Make sure the elders come, but bring in the children, too, even the nursing babies, Even men and women on their honeymoon-- interrupt them and get them there.

- 16 Gather the people, consecrate the assembly; bring together the elders, gather the children, those nursing at the breast. Let the bridegroom leave his room and the bride her chamber.
- 17 Between Sanctuary entrance and altar, let the priests, GOD's servants, weep tears of repentance. Let them intercede: "Have mercy, GOD, on your people! Don't abandon your heritage to contempt. Don't let the pagans take over and rule them and sneer, 'And so where is this God of theirs?'"
- 17 Let the priests, who minister before the LORD, weep between the temple porch and the altar. Let them say, "Spare your people, O LORD. Do not make your inheritance an object of scorn, a byword among the nations. Why should they say among the peoples, 'Where is their God?' "
- 18 At that, GOD went into action to get his land back. He took pity on his people.
- 18 Then the LORD will be jealous for his land and take pity on his people.
- 19 GOD answered and spoke to his people, "Look, listen--I'm sending a gift: Grain and wine and olive oil. The fast is over--eat your fill! I won't expose you any longer to contempt among the pagans.
- 19 The LORD will reply to them: "I am sending you grain, new wine and oil, enough to satisfy you fully; never again will I make you an object of scorn to the nations.
- 20 I'll head off the final enemy coming out of the north and dump them in a wasteland. Half of them will end up in the Dead Sea, the other half in the Mediterranean. There they'll rot, a stench to high heaven. The bigger the enemy, the stronger the stench!"
- 20 I will drive the northern army far from you, pushing it into a parched and barren land, with its front columns going into the eastern sea and those in the rear into the western sea. And its stench will go up; its smell will rise. Surely he has done great things.
- 21 Fear not, earth! Be glad and celebrate! GOD has done great things.
- 21 Be not afraid, O land; be glad and rejoice. Surely the LORD has done great things.
- 22 Fear not, wild animals! The fields and meadows are greening up. The trees are bearing fruit again: a bumper crop of fig trees and vines!
- 22 Be not afraid, O wild animals, for the open pastures are becoming green. The trees are bearing their fruit; the fig tree and the vine yield

their riches.

- 23 Children of Zion, celebrate! Be glad in your GOD. He's giving you a teacher to train you how to live right-- Teaching, like rain out of heaven, showers of words to refresh and nourish your soul, just as he used to do.
- 23 Be glad, O people of Zion, rejoice in the LORD your God, for he has given you the autumn rains in righteousness. He sends you abundant showers, both autumn and spring rains, as before.
- 24 And plenty of food for your body--silos full of grain, casks of wine and barrels of olive oil.
- 24 The threshing floors will be filled with grain; the vats will overflow with new wine and oil.
- 25 "I'll make up for the years of the locust, the great locust devastation-- Locusts savage, locusts deadly, fierce locusts, locusts of doom, That great locust invasion I sent your way.
- 25 I will repay you for the years the locusts have eaten-- the great locust and the young locust, the other locusts and the locust swarm-- my great army that I sent among you.
- 26 You'll eat your fill of good food. You'll be full of praises to your GOD, The God who has set you back on your heels in wonder. Never again will my people be despised.
- 26 You will have plenty to eat, until you are full, and you will praise the name of the LORD your God, who has worked wonders for you; never again will my people be shamed.
- 27 You'll know without question that I'm in the thick of life with Israel, That I'm your GOD, yes, your GOD, the one and only real God. Never again will my people be despised.
- 27 Then you will know that I am in Israel, that I am the LORD your God, and that there is no other; never again will my people be shamed.
- 28 "And that's just the beginning: After that-- "I will pour out my Spirit on every kind of people: Your sons will prophesy, also your daughters. Your old men will dream, your young men will see visions.
- 28 And afterward, I will pour out my Spirit on all people. Your sons and daughters will prophesy, your old men will dream dreams, your young men will see visions.
- 29 I'll even pour out my Spirit on the servants, men and women both.

- 29 Even on my servants, both men and women, I will pour out my Spirit in those days.
- 30 I'll set wonders in the sky above and signs on the earth below: Blood and fire and billowing smoke,
- 30 I will show wonders in the heavens and on the earth, blood and fire and billows of smoke.
- 31 the sun turning black and the moon blood-red, Before the Judgment Day of GOD, the Day tremendous and awesome.
- 31 The sun will be turned to darkness and the moon to blood before the coming of the great and dreadful day of the LORD.
- 32 Whoever calls, 'Help, GOD!' gets help. On Mount Zion and in Jerusalem there will be a great rescue--just as GOD said. Included in the survivors are those that GOD calls.
- 32 And everyone who calls on the name of the LORD will be saved; for on Mount Zion and in Jerusalem there will be deliverance, as the LORD has said, among the survivors whom the LORD calls.

Joel 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 "In those days, yes, at that very time when I put life back together again for Judah and Jerusalem,
- 1 In those days and at that time, when I restore the fortunes of Judah and Jerusalem,
- 2 I'll assemble all the godless nations. I'll lead them down into Judgment Valley And put them all on trial, and judge them one and all because of their treatment of my own people Israel. They scattered my people all over the pagan world and grabbed my land for themselves.
- 2 I will gather all nations and bring them down to the Valley of Jehoshaphat. There I will enter into judgment against them concerning my inheritance, my people Israel, for they scattered my people among the nations and divided up my land.
- 3 They threw dice for my people and used them for barter. They would trade a boy for a whore, sell a girl for a bottle of wine when they wanted a drink.

- 3 They cast lots for my people and traded boys for prostitutes; they sold girls for wine that they might drink.
- 4 "As for you, Tyre and Sidon and Philistia, why should I bother with you? Are you trying to get back at me for something I did to you? If you are, forget it. I'll see to it that it boomerangs on you.
- 4 Now what have you against me, O Tyre and Sidon and all you regions of Philistia? Are you repaying me for something I have done? If you are paying me back, I will swiftly and speedily return on your own heads what you have done.
- 5 You robbed me, cleaned me out of silver and gold, carted off everything valuable to furnish your own temples.
- 5 For you took my silver and my gold and carried off my finest treasures to your temples.
- 6 You sold the people of Judah and Jerusalem into slavery to the Greeks in faraway places.
- 6 You sold the people of Judah and Jerusalem to the Greeks, that you might send them far from their homeland.
- 7 But I'm going to reverse your crime. I'm going to free those slaves. I'll have done to you what you did to them:
- 7 See, I am going to rouse them out of the places to which you sold them, and I will return on your own heads what you have done.
- 8 I'll sell your children as slaves to your neighbors, And they'll sell them to the far-off Sabeans." GOD's Verdict.
- 8 I will sell your sons and daughters to the people of Judah, and they will sell them to the Sabeans, a nation far away." The LORD has spoken.
- 9 Announce this to the godless nations: Prepare for battle! Soldiers at attention! Present arms! Advance!
- 9 Proclaim this among the nations: Prepare for war! Rouse the warriors! Let all the fighting men draw near and attack.
- 10 Turn your shovels into swords, turn your hoes into spears. Let the weak one throw out his chest and say, "I'm tough, I'm a fighter."
- 10 Beat your plowshares into swords and your pruning hooks into spears. Let the weakling say, "I am strong!"
- 11 Hurry up, pagans! Wherever you are, get a move on! Get your act together. Prepare to be shattered by GOD!

- 11 Come quickly, all you nations from every side, and assemble there.
Bring down your warriors, O LORD!
- 12 Let the pagan nations set out for Judgment Valley. There I'll take my
place at the bench and judge all the surrounding nations.
- 12 Let the nations be roused; let them advance into the Valley of
Jehoshaphat, for there I will sit to judge all the nations on every side.
- 13 "Swing the sickle-- the harvest is ready. Stomp on the grapes-- the
winepress is full. The wine vats are full, overflowing with vintage evil.
- 13 Swing the sickle, for the harvest is ripe. Come, trample the grapes, for
the winepress is full and the vats overflow-- so great is their
wickedness!"
- 14 "Mass confusion, mob uproar-- in Decision Valley! GOD's Judgment
Day has arrived in Decision Valley.
- 14 Multitudes, multitudes in the valley of decision! For the day of the
LORD is near in the valley of decision.
- 15 "The sky turns black, sun and moon go dark, stars burn out.
- 15 The sun and moon will be darkened, and the stars no longer shine.
- 16 GOD roars from Zion, shouts from Jerusalem. Earth and sky quake in
terror. But GOD is a safe hiding place, a granite safe house for the
children of Israel.
- 16 The LORD will roar from Zion and thunder from Jerusalem; the earth
and the sky will tremble. But the LORD will be a refuge for his people, a
stronghold for the people of Israel.
- 17 Then you'll know for sure that I'm your GOD, Living in Zion, my
sacred mountain. Jerusalem will be a sacred city, posted: 'NO
TRESPASSING.'
- 17 Then you will know that I, the LORD your God, dwell in Zion, my holy
hill. Jerusalem will be holy; never again will foreigners invade her.
- 18 "What a day! Wine streaming off the mountains, Milk rivering out of
the hills, water flowing everywhere in Judah, A fountain pouring out of
GOD's Sanctuary, watering all the parks and gardens!
- 18 In that day the mountains will drip new wine, and the hills will flow
with milk; all the ravines of Judah will run with water. A fountain will
flow out of the LORD's house and will water the valley of acacias.
- 19 But Egypt will be reduced to weeds in a vacant lot, Edom turned into
barren badlands, All because of brutalities to the Judean people, the

atrocities and murders of helpless innocents.

19 But Egypt will be desolate, Edom a desert waste, because of violence done to the people of Judah, in whose land they shed innocent blood.

20 Meanwhile, Judah will be filled with people, Jerusalem inhabited forever.

20 Judah will be inhabited forever and Jerusalem through all generations.

21 The sins I haven't already forgiven, I'll forgive." GOD has moved into Zion for good.

21 Their bloodguilt, which I have not pardoned, I will pardon." The LORD dwells in Zion!